



USA Dodgeball Premier Tour Rules & Regulations

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RULES & REGULATIONS

Violations of these rules and regulations may result in disciplinary action within the confines of the sport, up to and including removal from play. No refunds are issued for disciplinary actions.

Failure to comply with these rules, regulations, and code of conduct may result in forfeiture of eligibility to participate in USA Dodgeball (USAD) events.

All USAD participants must adhere to the highest ethical standards during play. Repeated violations of the honor system may result in penalty cards and/or removal from competition.

Rules specific to a division are notated in *blue*.

HONOR SYSTEM

In dodgeball, the honor system is crucial to gameplay. Players must exit from play immediately upon being eliminated, regardless of whether a referee has made a call. Players are also responsible for ensuring their teammates exit play when eliminated, even in the absence of a referee's call. Any failure to comply with these self-enforcement requirements constitutes cheating.

****USAD and tournament staff reserve the right to make decisions in the spirit of fairness, even if a strict interpretation of the rules indicates a different ruling.***

DEFINITIONS

Live Ball	A ball that has been thrown and can get a player out.
Dead Ball	A ball that can no longer get a player out.
Dead Object	Anything that is not an active player in bounds or a live ball.
Active Player	A player on the roster who is participating in a game.
Inactive Player	A player on the roster who is not participating in a game.
Live Player	An active player who is not out.
Out Player	An active player who has been deemed out.



Entering Player	An active player who is in the process of re-entering play.
Exiting Player	An active player who is deemed out and going to the queue.
Possession	A ball within a team's half of the court, including areas outside the boundary lines.
Control	A ball secured by a live player with any part of their body, such that the player can intentionally retain, carry, or direct the ball without relying on contact with a surface, another object, or another player.
Short-handed	Starting a game with fewer players on the court.
Match	A series of games played between two teams in round robin or bracket play.
Burden	The obligation to throw.
Ricochet	A live thrown ball that hits a live player or a blocking ball and is not yet dead or caught.

GAMEPLAY

SPECIFICATIONS AND REQUIREMENTS

1. Balls

- a. A game is played with one of the following ball types.
 - i. WDBF-approved foam
 - ii. WDBF-approved cloth
 - iii. USAD-approved no-sting rubber
- b. **Foam & No-sting:** Six balls of identical color
- c. **Cloth:** Five balls of identical color

2. Apparel and Equipment

- a. Team Uniforms
 - i. Numbers on the front and back of uniforms are encouraged but not required.
 - ii. Uniforms must not contain vulgar or hateful content. Those that do may be grounds for eviction from the tournament with no refund if players refuse to remove the inappropriate items.



- iii. Alternate or warm-up uniforms are permitted, provided they are distinct from the opposing team's uniforms.
- iv. Sweatshirts and hoodies are prohibited during play.
- v. Referees must not wear uniforms of teams they are refereeing.
- b. Required Equipment
 - i. Closed-toe athletic shoes with non-marking soles.
 - ii. Team uniform that meets the specifications above.
- c. Permitted Equipment
 - i. Protective gear: Knee pads, elbow pads, braces, and arm sleeves.
 - ii. Head: Non-rigid athletic hats, sweatbands, and jerseys with hoods.
 - iii. Vision: Prescription contacts and protective eyewear (rec specs).
 - iv. Athletic tape (adhesive side must be closed).
 - v. Chalk for hand drying (must be fully absorbed before play).
- d. Prohibited Equipment
 - i. Footwear: Any footwear other than athletic shoes with non-marking soles, including cleats, raised heels, open-toed shoes, or bare feet.
 - ii. Head: Helmets
 - iii. Hand: Gloves of any kind, tar tape
 - iv. Vision: Standard eyeglasses
 - v. Upper body: Sweatshirts and hoodies
 - vi. Other: Any substances that may transfer to game balls
- e. Medical Exemptions
 - i. Players requiring prohibited equipment for medical reasons must:
 - 1. Submit documentation to the tournament staff before play begins.
 - 2. Receive written approval.
 - 3. Acknowledge assumption of any associated risks.
 - ii. Approved exemptions must be documented and available for referee review.

3. Court

- a. Standard Court Dimensions
 - i. The Playing Court is a rectangle measuring 59 feet by 29.5 feet, surrounded by free space, with a minimum of 3.25 feet on all sides.
 - 1. For Women's Foam and No-Sting competitions, there shall be a back line whose rear edge is drawn 1 meter (3.25) away from the rear edge of the back lines, toward the Center Line.



- b. See the Appendix for court diagrams for all three ball types.
- c. Attack Line Placement
 - i. **Foam & No-sting:** The attack line (also called the clear line) is marked 10' from the center line on each side of the court.
 - ii. **Cloth:** The attack line is placed 18' from the center line. A neutral zone is marked 6.5' on each side of the center line.
- d. Ball Placement Markers
 - i. **Foam & No-sting:** Two markers are placed on the center line, positioned 10' from each sideline and perpendicular to the center line. During setup, balls must be positioned between these markers and their respective sidelines. Teams may arrange their three balls within these designated areas as desired.
 - ii. **Cloth:** Ball placement markers are evenly positioned along the center line to accommodate the 5-ball setup.
- e. Out Queue:
 - i. The queue area for each team is a designated space measuring 3.5' x 15', positioned 3.5' from the court's side boundary. The queue's rear edge aligns with the back line of the court. Both team queues must be located on the same side of the court.

4. Players

- a. Team Capacity
 - i. A maximum of 9 players on a team's registered roster for open and women's divisions and 10 players for mixed divisions.
 - ii. A maximum of 5 players of each gender on a team's registered mixed roster.
 - iii. A minimum of 4 and a maximum of 6 players may start for each team.
 - 1. Failure to field a minimum of four players results in a game forfeiture.
 - 2. For mixed divisions, failure to provide at least 2 players of each gender results in a game forfeiture. If a team can only provide 2 players of one gender, they may still play with 5 total players. Teams may not play with 4 players of one gender.
 - iv. Players who do not start the game are not valid players to re-enter for catches. They are inactive.
 - 1. Players may only substitute between games or in case of injury.
 - v. All teams must designate a captain and/or a coach to communicate



with the referees.

1. Only the captain and/or coach may communicate with the ref. Violation of this policy may result in a Blue Card.

b. Registration & Membership Requirement

- i. All players on the court must be registered USAD members for the year in which the event occurs, prior to the games starting.
 1. Any teams attempting to play with non-USAD members are subject to disciplinary measures, including forfeit of the match and possible expulsion from the tournament with no refund.
- ii. All players must be registered for the event they are participating in.
- iii. Replacement players are allowed as long as they are USAD Members and registered for the event.
 1. Replacement players are those who register or replace at the last minute due to injury or dropout.
 2. Registration may happen on the day of, if necessary.

5. Team Names

- a. Team names must be appropriate and not considered derogatory or discriminatory regarding race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, age, disability, citizenship, or national origin.
- b. USAD reserves the right to require a team to change its name prior to an event and may decline participation from any team unwilling to comply.

OBJECTIVE, POINT SCORING, & TIMING

6. Match

- a. Before a match starts (during the round robin) or in the playoffs, the home team (higher-seeded team) must choose which side of the court they will start on.
- b. A standard round-robin match is 24 minutes (match time may vary by event). Teams play as many games as they can within that 24-minute match.
 - i. Timed matches begin regardless of whether the team is ready.
 1. If teams cannot start, refs start games manually, but the rest of the courts still end per the schedule.
 2. For every full minute a team is late, the other team receives a game win (max of 5 games).
 - ii. **Foam & No-Sting**
 1. Games have a 3-minute time limit. Teams play as many



games as possible within the overall 24-minute match.

2. To win a game and earn a point, a team must eliminate the entire opposing team.
3. If a game has not concluded within the time limit, it will enter No Blocking. Play is briefly stopped and resumes with the same players. Balls do not reset.
 - a. See the “No Blocking” section in Special Scenarios.
4. At the end of the 24-minute timer, the game is briefly stopped. It then resumes as a No Blocking game with the same players, and balls on the court reset to 3 on each side. The No Blocking game is played for a maximum of 3 minutes. No points are awarded if there is no clear winner within the 3-minute time limit.

iii. **Cloth**

1. Games have a 3-minute time limit. Teams play as many games as possible within the overall 24-minute match.
 - a. No Blocking is not played in the cloth format
 2. When the game time limit is reached, the team with more active players on the court wins. If there is an equal number of players on each side when the game time limit is reached, the game is tied.
 3. Wins are worth 2 points, ties 1 point, and losses 0 points.
 4. If a game ends with anywhere between 90 seconds and 3 minutes left on the overall match clock, a new game is started. The time limit of the new game aligns with the overall match clock.
 5. If less than 90 seconds remain on the match clock when a game ends, one final game with a 90-second time limit is played.
- c. Teams do not switch sides between games unless noted otherwise by the tournament director.

7. Bracket

- a. Bracket seeding
 - i. At the conclusion of Round Robin, teams are ranked using the following criteria. If multiple teams are tied on the first criterion, the next criterion is used to determine the higher seed. This continues until the tie is broken.
 1. Sum of Total Match Points
 - a. Match wins are worth 3 match points
 - b. Match ties are worth 1 match point
 - c. Match losses are worth 0 match points
 2. Total Game Points Scored



3. Game Points Differential
 4. Head-to-Head Outcome
 5. Coin Flip
- b. A standard bracket is a single elimination.
- i. The bracket will be split into an upper and lower bracket depending on the number of registered teams.
 1. 24 or more teams: an upper bracket of 16 teams.
 2. 12-23 teams: an upper bracket of 8 teams.
 3. Less than 12 teams: one bracket with all teams.
 - ii. In the single elimination bracket, standard rounds of play are 24-minute matches. Semifinal rounds of play are 30-minute matches. Final rounds of play are 40-minute matches.
 - iii. To win an elimination match, a team must have more points at the end of the set time.
 - iv. **Foam & No-sting:**
 1. Games have a 3-minute time limit. Teams play as many games as possible within the allotted match time.
 2. To win a game and earn a point, a team must eliminate the entire opposing team.
 3. If a game has not concluded within the time limit, it will enter No Blocking. The game is briefly stopped and resumes with the same players. Balls do not reset.
 4. At the end of the match clock, the game is briefly stopped. It then resumes as a No Blocking game with the same players, and balls on the court reset to 3 on each side. There is no time limit for the No Blocking game.
 5. If a winner cannot be determined after the end of the No Blocking game, a final overtime game is played, lasting up to 3 minutes.
 - a. If a winner has not been determined at the end of the 3-minute timer, the game is briefly stopped. It then resumes as a No Blocking game with the same players, and balls on the court resetting to 3 on each side.
 - v. **Cloth:**
 1. Each elimination round is played for the established match time. Games have a 3-minute time limit. Teams play as many games as possible within the allotted match time.
 - a. When the game time limit is reached, the team with more active players on the court wins. If there is an equal number of players on each side when the game



- time limit is reached, the game is tied.
- b. Wins are worth 2 points, ties 1 point, and losses 0 points.
- 2. If a game ends with anywhere between 90 seconds and 3 minutes left on the overall match clock, a new game is started. The time limit of the new game aligns with the overall match clock.
- 3. If less than 90 seconds remain in the match after a game ends, a final game lasting a maximum of 90 seconds is played.
- 4. If the score is tied at the end of a match, the match continues to an overtime game lasting up to 3 minutes.
 - a. If the teams have an equal number of players on the court at the end of the 3 minutes, the game enters sudden death. The first team to eliminate an opposing player wins the match.

GAME SETUP & FLOW

8. Ball Placement

- a. Six inactive balls are lined up on the center line.
- b. 3 balls for each team are placed within the 10' markers on each side of the court.
- c. Players may align their three balls to their liking within the ball placement markers on the center line in a timely manner.
- d. **Cloth**: At the start of a game, five inactive balls are placed on the center line markers, an equal distance apart based on the court width.

9. Beginning of Play

- a. Players must start with one foot on the back line and the other foot inside the boundary line.
- b. The referee follows these steps to begin play:
 - i. Call teams to line up and take their places.
 - ii. Verify teams are set by saying "Ready" to each team.
 - iii. Sound the whistle to begin play.

10. Opening Rush

- a. Players are out if they step on the sidelines during the opening rush.
- b. Players may touch or step over the center line to retrieve their team's designated balls, but not fully enter the opponent's side of the court.
- c. **Foam & No-sting**: Teams may only retrieve the three designated balls on their right.
- d. **Cloth**: Teams may only retrieve the two designated balls on their left. The



center ball is available for retrieval by both teams.

- i. Players may not slide or dive to retrieve the center ball.
- ii. Players may not touch or cross the center line when retrieving the center ball.
- iii. No physical contact between players is allowed when retrieving the center ball. Any offending player or players will be deemed out. Any incidental contact may not be penalized.
- iv. Once the ball has fully crossed the center line, possession belongs to the team that brought the ball to their side, and the opposing player must relinquish their grip on a contested ball.
 1. If a player fails to relinquish their grip on a contested ball once the opponent has established possession, the referee can issue a Blue Card if deemed excessive.
- e. A team may only retrieve their opponent's inactive balls if they have successfully cleared all of their designated balls. The opponent's inactive balls must be brought behind the retrieving team's attack line to become active.
 - i. If a team interferes with their opponent's inactive balls before they have cleared their own, the offending team forfeits all balls to the opposing team. Both teams start at their back line and all balls are activated when the referee restarts the game.
 - ii. Balls knocked over by the opponent to the opposite side may be activated after all of the team's designated balls have been activated.

11. Ball Activation

- a. Players must bring their respective balls behind their attack line (aka the clear line).
- b. A ball becomes active as soon as it fully crosses the clear line. Once activated, a ball is active for the rest of the game.
- c. If a ball is thrown that is not yet activated, the throwing player is out, and the ball remains inactive.
 - i. Any inactive ball can still be caught, but it is not a live ball that can hit opponents.
 - ii. Whichever team recovers a thrown inactive ball must activate the ball by bringing it behind the clear line.
- d. A valid and live thrown ball is still considered live if an opponent is attempting to block with an inactive ball during the opening rush.

12. False Start

- a. If a team removes their point of contact from the back line before the referee's signal, it is considered a false start. The referee stops play,

issues a verbal warning for the match, and resets the opening rush.

- b. If a team false-starts a second time (and for every additional false start) during a match, that team starts the current game with one out.
- c. **Cloth**: If a team false starts, the teams return to their end lines, and the opposing team is awarded all balls. The balls are immediately active when the game is started.
- d. If a team intentionally stalls in between games, per the referee's discretion, it is considered a false start. If a team continues to stall, a Yellow Card will be issued for manipulating the rule.

13. Burden to Throw

a. **Foam & No-sting**

- i. The home team has the initial burden at the start of each match.
- ii. The winner of the previous game starts with burden.
- iii. Once burden is established, only active players on the established side can relinquish burden with valid throws.
- iv. Burden is established by:
 - 1. Majority of balls, if equal then
 - 2. Majority of players, if equal then
 - 3. The team that did not have burden last
- v. Burden is reset by every valid throw from either team.

b. **Cloth**

- i. Burden is established by the majority of balls on one side.
 - 1. In situations where each team has an equal amount of balls, the officials will determine which team can be in possession of the majority of balls based on the nearest player to any dead ball within reachable distance on court.
- ii. Once burden is established, only active players on the established side can relinquish burden with valid throws.
- iii. Burden is relinquished once that side no longer has a majority of balls.
 - 1. If "play [n] balls" is called, burden is relinquished once that side has thrown n number of balls, with "n" being one less than the number of balls still in possession and no more than the number of live players on that team.

14. Throw Clock

- a. The throw clock begins when burden is established, regardless of the balls returning to the court or being held by retrievers.
- b. The original burden count does not stop unless play is stopped.
- c. A throw clock ends when the burden countdown reaches zero seconds,

and the referee says “zero.”

- d. If more balls are added to the side with burden, those balls do not count toward the original burden, and the original countdown does not reset.
- e. Live balls thrown before the throw clock reaches zero seconds must complete their sequence of play.
 - i. After the throw clock reaches zero seconds:
 - 1. No new throws are permitted by either team. A ball thrown after zero will be awarded to the opposing team.
 - 2. Players must allow ongoing sequences of play to complete. Interference with ongoing sequences will result in a verbal warning or Blue Card at the referee’s discretion.
- f. **Foam & No-sting**
 - i. The throw clock starts at 10 seconds, announced by a referee. The last 5 seconds (5 through 0) must be announced.
 - ii. Burden is relinquished when a live thrown ball is no longer in contact with a player’s hand. A team’s failure to relinquish burden results in forfeiting all balls to the opposing team.
 - 1. The referee briefly stops the game at zero to give the balls to the opposing team.
 - iii. After transitioning to No Blocking, the burden count resets at the end of a game or match.
- g. **Cloth**
 - i. The throw clock starts at 10 seconds, announced by a referee.
 - 1. The team with burden is given 5 seconds to make attempts to no longer be in possession of the majority of the balls.
 - 2. If after 5 seconds of having burden, the team is still in possession of the majority of the balls, the referee will call “play [n] balls”.
 - a. In the case of “play [n] balls”, n is one less than the number of balls still in possession and no more than the number of live players on that team.
 - b. If any players on the side with burden have clearly begun a throwing motion (defined by their throwing arm moving towards a live opponent), the official should delay the decision to call “play [n] balls” until the end of that throwing motion.
 - 3. After “play [n] balls” is called, the team with burden must make [n] attempts within 5 seconds.
 - 4. If a team has failed to make enough attempts within 5 seconds of “play [n] balls” being called, the following will occur:

- a. All players who were in control of a ball at the moment “play [n] balls” was called and failed to make an attempt are called out.
 - b. Additional players who were not in control of a ball are called out in order to meet the [n] requirement. The number of players being called out under this rule shall not exceed the number of balls that were in the team’s possession at the moment “play [n] balls” was called, but had not been thrown and did not result in a player being called out.
5. It is up to the captain or coach’s discretion to choose the players that are to be deemed out under 4(b). If a team fails to nominate enough players in a timely manner, the match officials will select the exiting players.
6. If a player in control of one or more balls has been eliminated before they could make an attempt, all balls in their control will be considered thrown for the purpose of “play n balls”.

15. Stoppage of Play

- a. When possible, the referee should stop play when no live balls are in flight, and no player is actively engaged in throwing, blocking, dodging, or catching.
 - i. Referees may delay a timing action to avoid interrupting an active play.
 - ii. Referees may stop play immediately to prevent a sequence of play beginning or resolving in error.
- b. The referee may pause the game, including the throw clock, to wait until the burden ball is back in play or into possession on the court sidelines.
 - i. If the referee does not pause the game but waits to start the throw clock until the burden ball is back on the court, play may continue.
- c. If the referee pauses the game, the throw clock restarts at the point where it was paused.
 - i. If the throw clock is paused at 4 seconds or less, the throw clock starts at 5 seconds when play resumes.
 - ii. **Cloth:** If the throw clock is paused during “play n balls”, the throw clock starts at 5 seconds, and “play n balls” will remain in effect.
- d. If any ball crosses the center line during a stoppage of play, that ball is returned to the originating side.
- e. Referees may overturn a play to make the correct ruling on the court.
- f. There are no timeouts during round robin matches.
- g. Each team is allowed 1 timeout per standard bracket match. Each team is allowed 2 timeouts per semifinal and final playoff match.

- i. Timeouts may last for up to 2 minutes
- ii. During a timeout, play is suspended, and all match and game clocks shall be stopped.
- iii. A timeout may only be requested between games or during a stoppage of play.

16. Ball States

a. Live Ball

- i. A live ball is defined as an activated ball thrown by an active player and is live until it becomes a dead ball.
 - 1. A throw must leave a player's hand. The thrown ball becomes a live ball once the player is no longer in contact with the ball.
 - a. **Cloth:** A ball that is blocked or ricocheted from one side of the court onto the other is also a live ball.
 - 2. The ball remains live until it is deemed dead, regardless of the status of the original throwing player.

b. Dead Ball

- i. A dead ball is defined as a live thrown ball that touches a surface, a dead object, or live thrown balls from opposing sides that have collided. It cannot cause an out during gameplay.
 - 1. Dead objects include the floor, walls, nets/barriers, referees, spectators, active same-side teammates, out players, inactive players, or another dead ball.

c. Popped Balls

- i. Popped balls are considered dead immediately.
- ii. The referee must immediately stop play and replace the popped ball.
- iii. Plays involving popped balls are negated, and play resets to before the throw.
- iv. The replacement ball is given to the team that had possession or whose side the ball was on when the ball was popped.

d. Contaminated Balls

- i. Any ball that contains blood or other substances is considered contaminated and must be popped and disposed of immediately.
- ii. The referee must stop play and replace the contaminated ball immediately. The replacement ball is given to the team in possession of the contaminated ball when gameplay stops.
- iii. All players must check themselves for blood or other substances and wash off promptly if needed. Gameplay is stopped.

e. Players may not place balls inside their jerseys.

17. Throwing

a. Valid Throw

- i. A valid throw is an attempt to hit an opposing player out. The live thrown ball must land or pass within 3' of a player or a player's position at the moment the ball was released.
- ii. A two-handed throw is a valid throw. Underhand, side-arm, and chest-pass throws are valid throws.
- iii. Throwing multiple balls at once is a valid throw.
- iv. Throwing at a ricocheted live ball to prevent an opponent from securing a catch is a valid throw.
- v. **Cloth:** Blockbacks or blocking attacks are considered a valid throw.
- vi. **Cloth:** Balls that ricochet off a live player from an opposing team and back into the throwing team are considered a valid throw.

b. Invalid Throw

- i. An invalid throw is a live thrown ball entering the opposing team's side of the court within more than 3' of a player or a player's position at the moment the ball was released.
- ii. Invalid throws do not relieve burden.
- iii. The first invalid throw of the match results in a verbal team warning; any additional instances from the same team result in the thrower being called out.
- iv. Spiking, slapping, punching, or kicking a ball is not a valid throw. The ball is dead, and the throw is invalid.
- v. Throwing a ball during any stoppage of play is invalid.

18. Sequence of Play

- a. A sequence of play begins with a live, valid throw and is completed when the ball is considered dead or caught.
- b. The referee's discretion determines the completion of a ball's sequence.
- c. A live thrown ball in mid-air when the game or match clock expires must still complete its sequence of play and can become dead or caught.

19. Ball Collision

- a. Ball Collision occurs when multiple balls collide in-flight before they hit another object or player.
- b. If a player's live thrown ball and an opponent's live thrown ball collide while in flight, both balls are immediately dead.
- c. If live thrown balls from the same team collide while in flight, those balls are considered live until they become a dead ball.
 - i. Ricochets remain live until they become dead.
- d. If a player executes a controlled drop of a live or active ball from their

possession and it is hit mid-air by a live thrown ball from the opponent, both balls are immediately dead.

20. Hitting

- a. A live player is deemed out when a live thrown ball that hits them on any part of their body (including hair, clothing, or accessories) is deemed dead.
 - i. **Cloth:** Fingers and hands are considered a part of the ball and are exempt from being hit. A live player is also deemed out when a live thrown ball hits them and touches another live player. The ball is still live until it completes its sequence.
- b. Once a player is deemed out, they become an exiting player and must raise their hand and immediately head to their team's designated queue.
- c. Single Ball Contact
 - i. If a player hits an opponent with a live ball, the opponent is out once the ball becomes dead, finishing its sequence of play.
 1. If a player deflects a live ball into their body with their blocking ball, they are out once the thrown ball becomes dead.
 2. If a player deflects a live ball with their blocking ball into their teammate, their teammate is out once that ball becomes dead.
 - ii. A live thrown ball can eliminate multiple players on the opposing team.
 1. If a player hits an opponent with a live ball, then the ball ricochets and hits another opponent, both opponents are out once that ball becomes dead.
 - iii. If a player hits the opponent's blocking ball with a live ball, forcing them to drop their blocking ball, and that blocking ball becomes dead, the opponent is out.
 - iv. If a player and opponent throw and hit each other, they are both out once those balls become dead.
 1. It is the referee's discretion whether a ball is released out of hand completely to be considered a live thrown ball.
 - v. If a live ball hits an opponent, ricochets, and hits a player from the throwing team, the ball is dead. Any throwing-team player is safe, and the opponent is out.
 1. **Cloth:** A live thrown ball that hits an opponent and ricochets back to the throwing team is considered live until it completes its sequence and can eliminate players on the throwing team.
 - vi. If at any time a ricocheted ball re-enters the throwing team's side, crossing the center line, that ball is deemed dead.
 1. **Cloth:** The ricocheted ball is live and completes its

sequence.

- vii. A trap is an out.
 - 1. A trap is defined as a live ball simultaneously hitting a player and the floor.
- viii. If a live ball hits any part of the opponent's head, it is an out once that ball becomes dead.
- ix. If a player is hit by a live ball that has not yet become dead, the player may continue to make valid actions until the ball that hit them becomes dead.
 - 1. If the ball becomes dead and the now dead player continues to intentionally initiate plays and interfere with the game, it is at the referee's discretion if the dead player is unaware of when they are deemed dead.
 - 2. The referee may provide a verbal warning or BlueCard to the dead player, depending on the level of interference.
- d. Multiple Ball Contact
 - i. If Player A is hit by Ball 1 and it ricochets, Player A is live and can make plays until Ball 1 is dead.
 - 1. If Player A is hit by Ball 1 and it ricochets, Player A or a teammate may make a play on Ball 1.
 - ii. If Player A is hit by Ball 2 after being hit by Ball 1, which is still in sequence, and then Ball 2 becomes dead, Player A is out. Ball 1 is still live until its sequence is complete. Player A is inactive and can no longer make a play on Ball 1.
 - 1. If a teammate catches Ball 1 after Player A is out by Ball 2, the catch is still valid.
 - 2. Player A is not eligible to be caught back in on the sequence of play because they were involved in the play.
 - 3. If Player A or a teammate catches Ball 1 after Player A catches Ball 2, both catches are valid.
 - 4. If Ball 1 ricochets from Player A to Player B, but Player A catches Ball 2 before Ball 1 completes its sequence of play, Ball 2 counts as a valid catch, Players A and B are out after Ball 1 is dead, and the thrower of Ball 2 is out.
 - iii. The referee's discretion determines the completion of Ball 1's sequence.
 - 1. If a ricocheted ball leaves the court, and if no active player can make a play on the ball per the referee's discretion, it is considered to have completed its sequence.
 - a. The player(s) hit by Ball 1 is immediately dead once Ball 1 becomes dead in this scenario.

21. Blocking

- a. A player may use a ball to block a live thrown ball, without resulting in the blocker being out.
 - i. A live thrown ball blocked with a ball is considered live until it finishes its sequence of play.
 - ii. **Cloth:** A live thrown ball that is blocked and ricocheted to the throwing team is considered live until it completes its sequence and can eliminate throwing team players.
- b. If a live thrown ball causes a blocking ball to be dropped and the dropped ball hits a surface, a dead object, or another player, the dropped blocking ball is dead, and the blocking player is out. The live thrown ball must still complete its sequence of play.
 - i. A teammate getting hit by the dropped ball is safe.
 - ii. A teammate cannot catch the dropped block to save a teammate.
- c. If a player drops their blocking ball after blocking a live thrown ball, then regains control of the blocking ball before the ball is deemed dead, the blocking player is safe.
- d. If a player holds a ball between their legs, that held ball is still eligible to be used as a blocking ball and to be knocked out, causing a potential out.
- e. Fingers and hands are not considered part of the blocking ball and result in an out if successfully hit.
 - i. **Cloth:** Fingers and hands are considered part of the blocking ball.

22. Catching

- a. Valid Catches
 - i. If a player catches a live ball from their opponent, the catch is valid. The thrower is out and becomes an exiting player, and the first teammate in the queue becomes an entering player.
 - ii. A player must demonstrate control and have one point of contact inbounds to complete a valid catch.
 - 1. A player may catch a ball between their legs.
 - 2. If the player is hit by another live ball, the player must have completed the catch prior to the second ball completing its sequence to be a valid catch.
 - iii. Players may not use their jersey as a net to catch a ball. The catch is invalid, and the catching player is out.
- b. Catching Scenarios
 - i. If a live ball hits an opponent, ricochets, and is caught by their teammate, the catch is valid. The hit player(s) is safe.
 - 1. **Cloth:** The hit player(s) is not safe.
 - ii. If a live ball hits an opponent, ricochets, and their teammate catches



it after the player has stepped out of bounds, the catch is valid.

1. If the player who is hit by a live ball walks out of bounds and is unaware of the ricocheted catch by a teammate, the hit player may re-enter the game at the referee's discretion.
- iii. If a player catches multiple live balls simultaneously, the catches are valid. The throwers are out, and the number of valid balls caught results in the number of players that may re-enter.
- iv. If a player and an opponent throw at each other and both catch their opponent's ball simultaneously, both catches are valid.
 1. If Player A and Player B throw at each other, Player A demonstrates control before Player B, Player A's catch is valid, and Player B is out.
- v. If a live ball hits an opponent, ricochets, and a player from the throwing team catches that ball, the catch is not valid, and the opponent is out.
 1. **Cloth:** The catch is valid, and the opponent is out.
- vi. Each live ball thrown by a player is eligible for one valid catch for the opposing team.
 1. A thrown ball that occurs after the thrower is considered out is not eligible for a catch.
 2. If a player throws more than one live ball, each thrown ball is eligible for one valid catch for the opposing team.
- vii. Active players can jump to tip a live ball or ricochet it to their teammates for a catch.
 1. If the player tipping a ball lands out of bounds before or after the ricochet catch, the player is out and is ineligible to return for the catch because they were involved in the same sequence of play.
- viii. While a player is attempting to make a catch, it is the referee's discretion if a ball has slipped out while going for another catch, dodge, or block.
- ix. While a player is attempting to make a catch, it is the referee's discretion if a ball has slipped out because the floor or a teammate has knocked the ball out of possession.
- x. If a player is hit by a live ball and falls out of bounds, the ball remains live for teammates, but the player is out for falling out of bounds and cannot be saved from a team catch.
 1. The player who fell out of bounds is out and is ineligible to return for the catch because they were involved in the same sequence of play.
- xi. If a player is hit by Ball 1, then by Ball 2, the player is out once Ball

- 1 completes its sequence; catching Ball 2 is not a valid catch.
 - 1. If the thrower of Ball 2 walks out of bounds and is unaware of the invalid catch, then the thrower may re-enter the game per the referee's discretion.
- xii. If a player completes a catch, and then their momentum takes them out of bounds, the catch is valid, but the player is out.
- xiii. A valid catch that occurs as or after the game or match clock expires will still result in the thrower being out and an entering player coming in.
- xiv. Blocked Catch
 - 1. If an opposing player blocks a live thrown ball that ricochets, and the blocker or a teammate catches the ricocheted ball, the catch is valid.
 - 2. **Cloth**: If an opposing player blocks a live thrown ball that ricochets, and the throwing team catches the ricocheted ball, the catch is valid, and the blocker is out.
 - 3. After blocking a ball, a player may intentionally drop the blocking ball in order to catch the ricocheted ball.
- xv. Referee discretion upholds all other catching scenarios.

23. Player Entry

- a. One catch from one live ball brings in one teammate as an entering player in the order in which they were deemed out.
 - i. Entry out of order results in the player going to the back of the queue. No player becomes an entering player from that catch. If the player who re-enters also commits interference, a Blue Card is given per the referee's discretion.
 - ii. If the first player in the queue enters the game in error, the team is given a verbal warning. If an entry in error causes interference, a Blue Card is issued per the referee's discretion.
- b. A player re-entering a game has 5 seconds to enter the court. Failure to do so may result in the player being denied re-entry, and that player must begin at the back of the team re-entry order.
- c. Players must re-enter along the back line.
- d. An entering player is live once that player has established one point of contact inside the court.
- e. The starting six players for a game may be the only players to re-enter from catches for that game.
- f. If a catch is complete and valid before the entering player of the catching team reaches the queue, that player may touch the queue and re-enter immediately via the back line.
- g. A player cannot become an entering player on the same sequence of play

as a valid catch, even if they were able to reach the queue before the catch.

24. Ball Retrieval

- a. Active players may not leave the court at any time to retrieve a ball.
- b. Designated Ball Retrievers
 - i. Only designated ball retrievers are allowed to retrieve stray balls. A maximum of three people may be designated as ball retrievers per team.
 - 1. Active players cannot be designated ball retrievers. Inactive players can be designated ball retrievers.
 - 2. Designated ball retrievers must be determined and communicated to the referee before the match begins.
 - 3. Designated ball retrievers may be switched after each game, but must make it clear to the referees.
 - 4. Designated ball retrievers may only retrieve balls on their half of the court and may not cross or reach over the extended center line.
 - 5. Designated ball retrievers may not enter the court to provide a stray ball.
 - ii. Retrieved balls may be held on the sidelines by ball retrievers. Burden is still determined and established.
 - iii. **Cloth:** Retrieved balls must be put back into play between the attack line and the back line.
 - iv. Retrieved balls may be passed to live players or other ball retrievers.
 - v. If a person who is not a designated ball retriever interferes with a stray ball to manipulate the game to a team's favor:
 - 1. The referee decides whether a non-match participant was tossing a ball back into play to continue the game or interfering with a ball to favor a team.
 - 2. If a referee determines that a person who is not a designated ball retriever was interfering with the ball to favor a team, the referee stops play, awards the opposing team that ball, and continues play at their signal.
 - 3. If a ball is thrown over by a non-match participant to the side the ball went out on, but goes to the opposite team without receiving team interference, the ball shall be returned to the team that would have retrieved the ball.
- c. A ball can only be retrieved once it is completely out of the court.
 - i. Any ball sitting on the line is considered inside the court.



- ii. Any designated ball retriever that touches a ball that is still on the court results in forfeiting that ball to the opposing team.
- iii. Any person who is not a ball retriever who attempts to retrieve a ball forfeits that ball to the opposing team.
 - 1. This includes retrievers in addition to the allotted three designated retrievers
- d. Active players on the court are allowed to reach over any line to retrieve any stray balls without touching out of bounds or their opponent's zone.
 - i. Designated ball retrievers are prohibited from fighting for stray balls with active players.
 - ii. The stray ball is always rewarded to the active player if both the active and inactive player or the designated ball retriever possess the stray ball.
 - iii. If a designated ball retriever fights for a stray ball with an active player, this will result in the ball being forfeited to the opposing team and a Blue Card if deemed excessive.
- e. Balls being retrieved must go to the team on the side of the court's center line where the ball is picked up.
 - i. If a team's ball retriever accidentally gives the ball to the opposite team, the ball shall remain with the team that recovers the retrieved ball.
- f. Balls cannot be held in the queue. Balls held in the queue are forfeited to the opposing team.
- g. Players can not have a ball in hand until they establish themselves as an active player on the court. If an entering player carries, rolls, or intentionally touches a ball before becoming a live player, that ball is forfeited to the opposing team, and the player is out.

SPECIAL SCENARIOS

25. Out of Bounds

- a. Stepping on any boundary line results in an out. The player is considered dead immediately and cannot make any plays.
 - i. Boundary lines include the sideline, backline, center line, and **Cloth** neutral zone line.
 - ii. Players may cross the center line during the opening rush. **Cloth:** Except when rushing for the middle ball.
 - iii. If a ball is thrown as a player steps out of bounds, the throwing player is out, but the throw can still relieve burden.
 - 1. The ball can still be caught, but it is not a live ball and cannot hit opponents.
- b. If any part of a player touches a dead object that is not a ball, a non-active



player, or a surface outside the boundary lines, they are considered out of bounds.

- i. Active players who use a held ball to touch out of bounds are considered out of bounds.
 - ii. Active players may reach over any out-of-bounds line to retrieve a ball.
- c. Players may only leave the court when they are out, injured, the referee allows it, or when the referee has stopped play.

26. One Versus One

- a. If a player and their opponent throw a live ball at each other and both hit, the referees determine who is out based on which ball's sequence of play ended first.
 - i. The referee resets the play when a result cannot be determined. Both players start at the end line with the current burden and begin play upon the referee's signal.
- b. If a player touches out of bounds after successfully hitting the opponent, the referee must determine when the live thrown ball became dead and when the player touched out of bounds.
 - i. If the player touched out of bounds before the thrown ball became dead, the opponent receives the win.

27. No Blocking

- a. During No Blocking, a held ball acts as an extension of the body. A thrown ball is still live when it contacts a player's blocking ball and may be caught or ricocheted into other players.
- b. A player who blocks a ball is not immediately dead; that player remains alive until the blocked ball completes its sequence.
- c. If the match clock expires while already in No Blocking, play continues without interruption. Balls do not reset, and the current game is played as if it were a match end No Blocking game.

28. Pinching

- a. For all divisions, players may not pinch or grip the ball, causing foam-to-foam or rubber-to-rubber contact at any time, including throwing or blocking.
 - i. Players may only open-hand or clamp-throw a ball.
 - ii. Pinched throws or blocks are not outs for either team. The first offense by a player results in a verbal warning at the referee's discretion.
 - iii. Any subsequent offense for pinched throws or pinched blocks results in the player being out and receiving a Blue Card.

29. Flight Kills

- a. A flight kill is an aerial act of jumping into the opponent's zone and hitting an opponent with a live thrown ball before the flight player lands.
- b. Flight kills (or "suicides") are not allowed.
- c. A player who attempts a flight kill will be immediately called out, and any play made by the offending player's team during the flight kill is considered invalid. Play is reset.

30. Injuries

- a. The referee must stop gameplay immediately if there are any injuries.
 - i. The seriousness of the injury determines the allowance of time needed to pause the game.
 - ii. If a player is fit to continue, both teams begin on their respective end lines and resume gameplay with the current burden at the referee's signal.
 - iii. If a live player is not fit to continue playing, an inactive player may enter the game as a substitute at the end of the queue. The first player in the queue may enter the court immediately.
 1. If a player is replaced during a game, they may not participate in the match as an active player until the next match after the current match concludes.
 2. If a team fakes an injury to substitute another player, the team may be ejected from the tournament and forfeit any final awards for that tournament.
- b. Referees or tournament staff may, at their discretion, substitute players if they determine that a player poses an unreasonable risk to themselves or others.

31. Interference

- a. Players who are deemed out or inactive may not interfere with the game, the balls on the court, or active players.
 - i. Out players intentionally interfering with a game are issued a verbal warning and a Blue Card if it persists.
 - ii. Players deemed out must exit the court and enter their queue immediately.
 - iii. Players who are deemed out while holding a ball are allowed to pass the held ball to their teammate. They must then exit the court immediately to the side or back lines.
 1. **Cloth**: An exiting player holding a ball in front of their attack line must place the ball down where they are standing. If they pass the ball to anyone, that ball is forfeited to the opposing team, and the player receives a verbal warning. Continuing to



violate this rule results in a Blue Card.

2. Players may not cross into the opposing side of the court to exit. Any perceived attempt to harass, threaten, or interfere with an opponent's gameplay through crossing the center line is issued a Yellow Card.
- iv. If a player becomes dead by stepping on or over any boundary while throwing, then any action that follows in the sequence is considered invalid.
 1. The referee reverses any outs, allows the appropriate players back into play, and the player who stepped over the line committing the throw is deemed out.
 2. This is not considered interference.
- v. If a referee recognizes that a player is deemed dead and the player continues to make plays, the referee must stop play. The referee will then provide a verbal warning or Blue Cards at their discretion.
 1. The referees will reset both sides with balls in hand and current burden, if needed.
- b. The throwing team can knock the ball away after hitting their opponent if they are in reach and before a catcher secures the ball, as long as the throwing team players are active and in bounds. This is not considered interference.
 - i. If a player collides with an opponent while trying to knock a ball away, the referee can determine whether the collision was intentional and may provide a Red Card.
- c. The referees may provide Yellow and Red Cards depending on the severity of intentional interference.
- d. Inactive players, ball retrievers, other teams, and spectators may not interfere with gameplay at any point.
 - i. They may not toss a stray ball in the court to manipulate the outcome of a play.
 - ii. If interference occurs on a team's behalf, that team will receive a verbal warning and a Blue Card if deemed excessive.

32. Player Collision

- a. Both teams must make every effort to avoid physical collisions with the opposing team.
- b. Any collision may result in the referee stopping play.
- c. Intentional collision results in an out and a Red Card.
 - i. It is at the referee's discretion if a player is attempting to intentionally collide with another player or avoid collision.
- d. Repeat offenders in the same match receive a Red Card.

33. Undocumented Rules

- a. An undocumented rule occurs when a play or situation occurs that has no recorded ruling.
- b. Referees must quickly reach a logical, unbiased agreement, referring to the sequence of play.
- c. If the referees can make no logical agreement, play resets.
- d. The undocumented rule does not affect gameplay. A reset of play forces both teams to start on their end line.
- e. The head referees of that match must report all undocumented rules to tournament staff.

DISCIPLINARY MEASURES

Disciplinary measures are enforced for all players, coaches, ball retrievers, referees, and spectators. The USAD Executive Board and tournament staff will determine if further disciplinary measures are required. All final say is determined by the Judiciary Committee as needed.

34. Verbal Warning

- a. Match referees and tournament staff may give verbal warnings during gameplay as a reminder to keep the play continuing.
- b. Warning offenses include the following:
 - i. Invalid throws.
 - ii. Inactive players unintentionally stepping onto the court while the game is still in process.
 - iii. Minor interference per the referee's discretion.
 - iv. Pinch throwing or pinch blocking.
 - v. False starts during the opening rush.
 - vi. Minor verbal taunting, jeering, screaming, and temper tantrums.
 - vii. Players who are not captains questioning a ref's call.
 - viii. Wearing apparel that is not permitted.
- c. Verbal warnings do not carry over from one match to the next.
- d. A player may receive only one verbal warning per match for a specific offense. If any further offense warrants an additional verbal warning to be given to a single player in the same match, it is given as a Blue Card instead.

35. Blue Card

- a. A Blue Card may be given by match referees or tournament staff during gameplay. A Blue Card can also be given by the Judiciary Committee after

- a tournament.
- b. A Blue Card is defined as a minor penalty to the player who received it. The receiving player must leave the court and enter the back of the queue. The player may be caught back in.
 - i. If a Blue Card is given to a player between games of a match, the team must start the next game with a player in the queue. A player is eligible to re-enter the game on a catch.
 - ii. If a Blue Card is given to a non-live player during a game, then one live player must leave the court and enter the back of the queue. The team captain chooses which player to remove.
- c. If only one live player remains on the court when a Blue Card is given, the game is forfeited, as the team will have no players left on the court.
- d. A player may receive only one Blue Card per match for the same offense. If any further offense warrants an additional Blue Card to be given to a single player in the same match for the same offense, it is given as a Yellow Card instead.
 - i. A player may also only receive a Blue Card a total of two times within a match. If any further offense warrants an additional Blue Card to be given to a single player in the same match, it is given as a Yellow Card instead.
- e. Blue Card offenses include the following:
 - i. Any non-captain arguing with a referee.
 - ii. Any non-captain arguing with the opposing team.
 - iii. Any captain arguing excessively or in an aggressive manner with a referee or opposing team.
 - iv. Pinching a dodgeball during gameplay.
 - v. Interference per the referee's discretion.
 - vi. Failing to relinquish a ball possessed by the opposing team during the opening rush
 - vii. A ball retriever is excessively fighting with a live player for a stray ball.
 - viii. Wearing apparel or equipment that is not permitted after a verbal warning.
 - ix. Taunting an opponent.

36. Yellow Card

- a. A Yellow Card may be given by the match referees or tournament staff during or immediately after gameplay. A Yellow Card can also be given after a tournament by the Judiciary Committee.
- b. A Yellow Card is a penalty imposed on the player who receives it. The player must leave the court, cannot be caught back in, and must sit out the

next bracket match.

- i. In the game following a Yellow Card offense, the offending team must also start with one less player on the court for every Yellow Card received in the previous game. An additional player is not eligible to re-enter the game on a catch.
- ii. If the Yellow Card(s) is given after the tournament, the offending player will serve their penalty at the next USAD tournament they participate in. However, if they are playing with a different team, that team will not be penalized for starting with one fewer player.
- c. Yellow Card offenses include the following:
 - i. Verbal aggression and threats to any opponent or referee.
 - ii. Taunting or intimidating any referee.
 - iii. Playing in a division without registering for it.
 - iv. Cheating or manipulating a rule.
 - v. Attempting to use video replay on a referee's decision.
 - vi. Bringing foreign objects onto the court that are not part of the game.
 - vii. Receiving a third Blue Card in a match.
- d. If a player receives a second Yellow Card during the same tournament, the player is issued a Red Card instead.
- e. If a player refuses to serve out their penalty and plays a match they are not eligible for, they are issued a Red Card, and the team will forfeit their next bracket match.

37. Red Card

- a. A Red Card may be issued by match referees or tournament staff during gameplay or retroactively after the game. A Red Card can also be given after a tournament by the Judiciary Committee.
- b. A Red Card is a penalty issued to a player. The player must leave the court, cannot be brought back in, and is suspended for the remainder of the match. The player must sit out the next 3 bracket matches.
 - i. If the team is eliminated before the player serves their 3-match penalty, the remaining penalties will carry over to the next USAD division/tournament the player participates in.
 - ii. The offending team must also start with 1 fewer player for the 3 matches the offending player is suspended. An additional player is not eligible to re-enter the game on a catch.
- c. If the Red Card(s) is given after the tournament or if the player has not served their 3 bracket match suspension, the offending player will serve their penalty at the next USAD tournament they participate in. However, if they are playing with a different team, that new team will not be penalized with having to start with 1 fewer player.



- d. If a player refuses to serve out their penalty and plays a match they are not eligible for, they will be issued a Red Card, and the team will forfeit their next bracket match.
- e. Red Card offenses include the following:
 - i. Two Yellow Card offenses in the same match by the same team.
 - ii. Intentionally kicking a ball in an aggressive manner.
 - iii. Intentional ball deflation or damage.
 - iv. Intentionally colliding with an opponent during gameplay.
 - v. Committing any verbal offense to any referee, player, or spectator, including racial slurs or discriminatory comments.
 - vi. Any physical altercation between players before, during, or after gameplay.
 - vii. Spitting at any player, spectator, or referee.
 - viii. If a player receives two Red Cards in a tournament, the player will be ejected.

38. Ejection

- a. An ejection results in any player, coach, referee, or spectator being disqualified from continuing to participate in the event, and that individual must leave the premises of the venue immediately.
- b. Ejections are only enforced by the USAD Executive Board and Tournament Directors.
- c. Ejection offenses include, but are not limited to, the following:
 - i. Two Red Cards in the same event.
 - ii. Physical fighting.
 - iii. Refusal to remove uniforms containing hateful or vulgar content.
 - iv. Intentionally vandalizing the venue or equipment, including equipment from USAD or any player.
 - v. Spectators harassing and interfering with participants or gameplay.
 - vi. Participants harassing the spectators.
 - vii. Providing alcohol and illegal drugs at the event.
 - viii. Heavily intoxicated participants.
 - ix. Using objects as weapons to harm participants.
- d. If any ejection offense occurs at the end of an event or is discovered after the event has concluded, the USAD Executive Board or Judiciary Committee may ban the offending person from future events.

39. Referee Eviction

- a. A referee may be evicted if it is deemed that the designated referee is not enforcing the responsibilities and guidelines correctly.



- b. An eviction of a referee revokes the participant's eligibility for referee compensation, and the referee may not continue to referee gameplay for the event.
- c. A referee's eviction has no impact on the disciplinary measures as a player.
- d. The team of the evicted referee must provide a replacement referee.

40. Expulsion

- a. An expulsion is defined as an official ban by USAD of any participant or spectator who poses a serious threat to the organization or its participants.
- b. Participants who are expelled are not allowed to re-enter any USAD-sanctioned event unless approved by the USAD Executive Board.

41. Overturning Cards

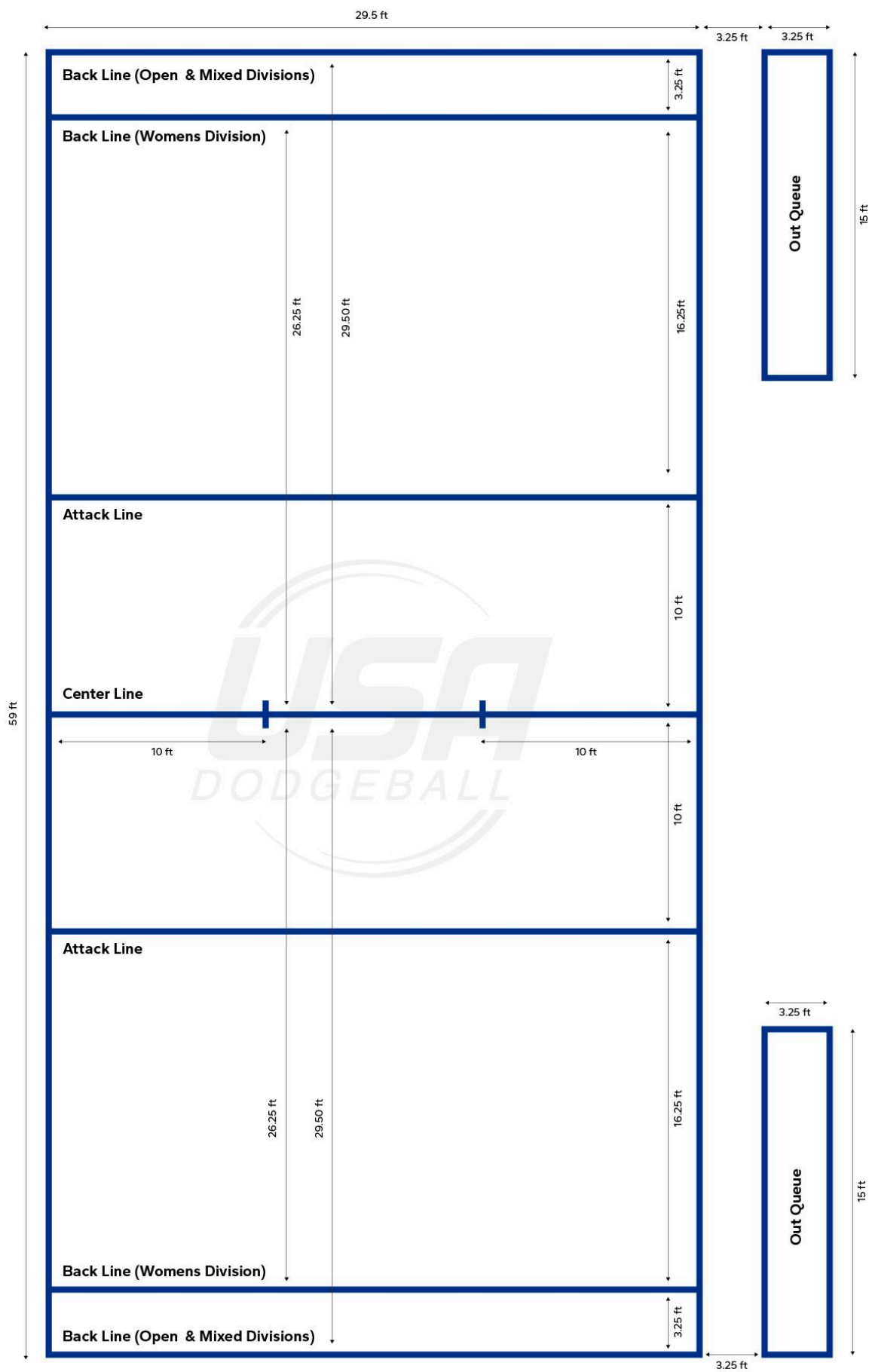
- a. No cards may be overturned by anyone other than the Judiciary Committee or the Executive Board.
- b. Final answer/decisions must be delivered before the next attended USA Dodgeball event by carded player(s).

*****USAD Executive leadership reserves the right to make exceptions in the spirit of fairness, even if a strict interpretation of the rules indicates a different ruling.*****

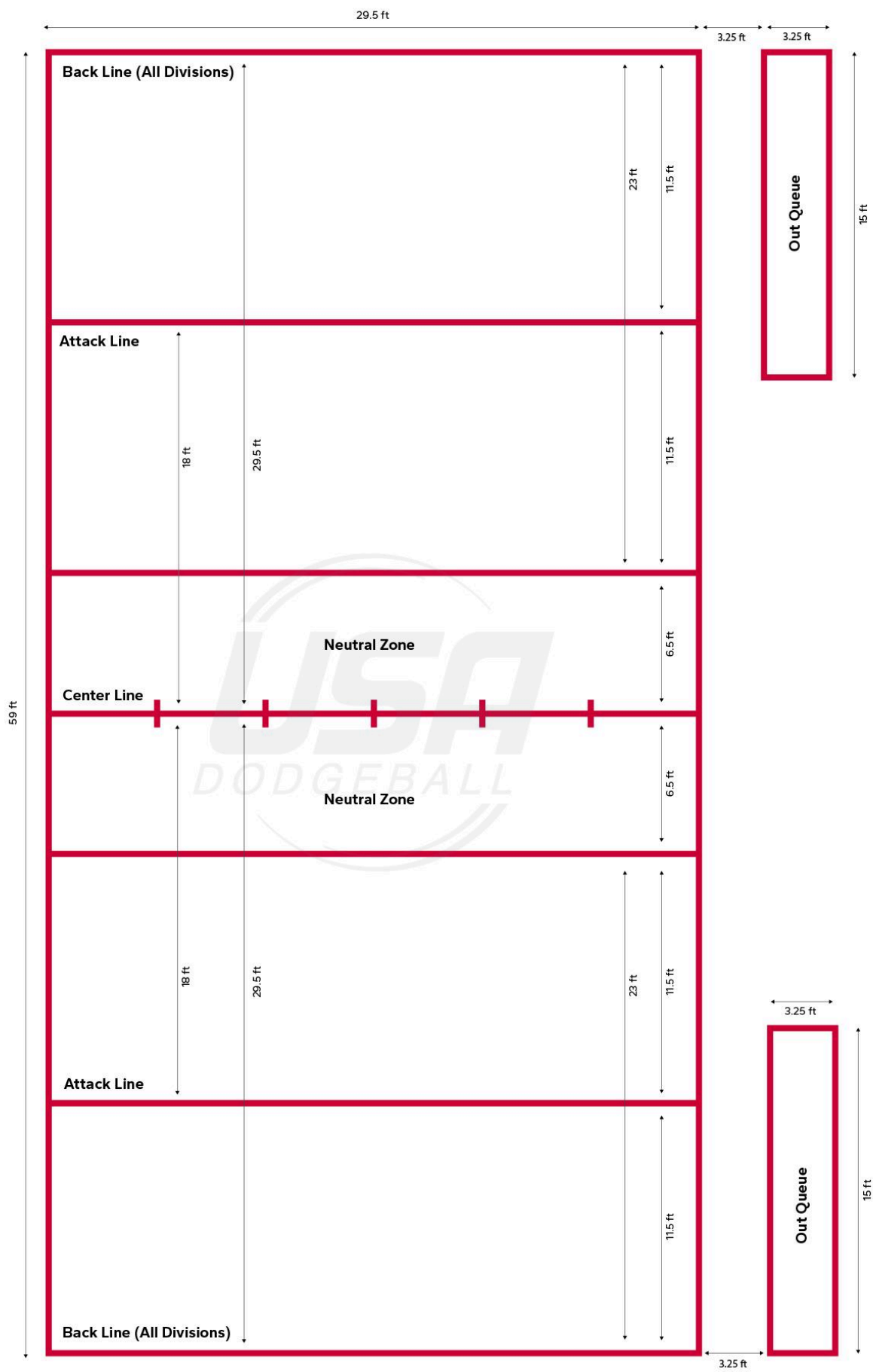
APPENDIX

See images below for court dimension diagrams.

FOAM COURT DIMENSIONS



CLOTH COURT DIMENSIONS



NO-STING COURT DIMENSIONS

